

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, March 2, 2026, at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Charisse Fain; Commissioners: R. Dan Brummitt, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., Valencia L. Perry, and Yolanda Feimster

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Dywanda Pettaway.

Pastor Abidan Shah, Clearview Baptist Church, gave the invocation.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team member, was first on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. Employees are nominated by their peers, and this month's recognition goes to Ms. Cora Fields with the Vance County Department of Social Services. Her peers noted that she is always willing to help others, is a team player, and is extremely dependable. Ms. Fields will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated her on receiving this recognition.

Public comments were heard next. There were three individuals that signed up. Kelley Perdue, Angie Ryan, and Mary Susan Williams all spoke to the board also on the topic of taxes.

Code Enforcement, Bob Rosch, was next on the agenda and presented information on an idea of the city and county having one location for enforcement, planning, and zoning. This was for informational purposes only.

Animal Controller, William Coker, was next on the agenda and presented to the board for consideration of approval a termination of trust for the Vance County Animal Shelter, from the estate of Mr. & Mrs. John and Betty Church. Following the discussion, motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to agree and consent to dissolve the trust and split the proceeds accordingly.

Assistant EMS Director, William Jenkins, was next on the agenda to present to six individuals the EMS Lifesaver Award. The six individuals were as follows: Captain Justin Boyd, Vance County EMS; Captain Quentin Woody, Vance County EMS; Paramedic Aaron Whitby,

Vance County EMS; Firefighter Jodi Watkins, Hicksboro Fire Dept; and Firefighter Angie Jefferson, Hicksboro Fire Dept.

Finance Director's Report

Cash Handling During Coin Shortage. Finance Director Stephanie Williams presented to the board for consideration of approval the Vance County Penny Shortage Policy. She noted that the Vance County Penny Policy establishes standardized procedures for handling cash transactions during periods of penny shortages. The policy allows for rounding of change only to the nearest \$0.05 when exact change cannot be made while maintain consistency, fairness to the customers, and strong internal controls. It encourages alternative payment methods, requires public notice through signage, and outlines staff and supervisory responsibilities for monitoring coin inventory and reconciling cash drawers. The policy ensures compliance with applicable audit standards, North Carolina General Statutes #159, and County financial management requirements and will remain in effect until the shortage is resolved or new guidance is issued. Recommendation is to approve the Vance County Penny Shortage Policy as presented.

Motion made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the Vance County Penny Shortage as presented.

Assistant County Manager's Report

EMS Substation: Architectural and Engineering firm Staff Recommendation. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones reported that Vance County issued a Request for Qualifications (RFQ) for professional architectural services related to the planning, design, and construction administration of a new EMS Substation. The RFQ process was conducted in accordance with North Carolina statutes governing the procurement of architectural services, including the qualifications-based selection requirements outlined in N.C.G.S. §143-64.31. The County received multiple responses from qualified firms. A staff evaluation committee reviewed all submittals using criteria established in the RFQ, including: • Relevant project experience, • Firm qualifications and staffing capacity, • Understanding of project scope and approach, • Experience with emergency services and public safety facilities, • References and past performance, and • Ability to meet project timeline and budget objectives

Based on the initial evaluation, a shortlist of firms was selected and invited to participate in interviews. Interviews were conducted via Microsoft Teams on February 17, 2026. Following interviews and final scoring, the evaluation committee determined that Oakley Collier Architects

demonstrated the strongest overall qualifications, project understanding, and ability to successfully deliver the EMS Substation project. Should negotiations not result in satisfactory agreement, staff will return to the Board with alternative recommendations consistent with the RFQ ranking process. Funding for design services will be incorporated within the approved project budget for the EMS Substation which will come before you at a later date. Final costs will be presented to the Board as part of the negotiated contract for approval. Recommendation: Staff recommends that the Board of Commissioners: Accept the results of the competitive qualifications-based selection process; and authorize the County Manager and County Attorney to negotiate contract terms with Oakley Collier Architects for architectural services associated with the EMS Substation project.

Motion made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote passed 6-1, Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt voted no, to accept the results of the competitive qualifications-based selection process; and authorize the County Manager and County Attorney to negotiate contract terms with Oakley Collier Architects for architectural services associated with the EMS Substation project.

Award of Service Weapon and Badge. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones reported that Sheriff Curtis Brame has requested the award of the service weapon and badge to Sergeant Clevon Dozier following his retirement March 1, 2026. He has served Vance County for approximately 17.5 years. As per county policy, he is eligible to receive his service weapon and badge. Recommendation: Award service weapon and badge to retired Sergeant Clevon Dozier according to county policy.

Motion made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote was unanimous, to award the service weapon and badge to retired Sergeant Clevon Dozier according to county policy.

County Manager's Report

Health Insurance and Vacation Accrual Changes. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that for more than 25 years, Vance County has provided employee-only health insurance at no cost to employees. This benefit has been valued by staff and remains an important component of the County's overall compensation package. However, rising healthcare costs now require the County to evaluate long-term sustainability while continuing to support employee recruitment and retention. For the current fiscal year, the County experienced a \$1.2 million increase in health insurance costs. This increase significantly impacts the General Fund and

limits the County's ability to address other critical needs, including salary adjustments, staffing levels, and service delivery. To help partially offset this increase, staff is requesting Board consideration of implementing a \$50 per month employee premium for employee-only health insurance coverage. Based on current enrollment, this change is estimated to generate approximately \$225,000 in annual revenue, which would help mitigate, but not fully offset the increased cost of the County's health insurance program. Recognizing that this would be the first employee premium contribution in over two decades, staff is also proposing a corresponding enhancement to employee benefits. Specifically, the County would revise its vacation accrual policy so that an employee's time in the North Carolina Government Retirement System (LGERS and TSERS) is credited toward vacation accrual eligibility. This change would allow employees to receive vacation accruals that more accurately reflect their total years of public service, rather than only their years of service with Vance County. This will apply to current staff as well as new recruits. Recommendation is to approve the employee health insurance premium and direct staff to prepare and implement a policy addressing the vacation accrual adjustment effective July 1, 2026. The health insurance premium changes shall apply to all employees enrolled in the health plan, while the vacation accrual adjustments shall apply only to employees eligible to earn vacation leave.

Following a discussion, a motion made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt , seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to table the recommendation for the health insurance so a discussion can be had during the next budget work session.

A motion was then made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote passed 4-3, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Valencia Perry, and Yolanda Feimster voted no, to approve implementing a policy addressing the vacation accrual adjustment effective July 1, 2026.

Birthday Leave. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that Staff proposes the implementation of a Birthday Leave benefit to recognize and honor employees. Eligible full-time employees in regular budgeted positions would receive four (4) hours of paid leave to be used on or within ninety (90) days of their legal birthday. Unused leave will be forfeited and is not eligible for payout upon separation. Key Parameters: eligibility after six months of employment; advance request required for scheduling purposes; no rollover or cash-out; leave must be taken in

one increment; and employees on Leave Without Pay are not eligible. Recommendation is to approve the birthday leave policy effective 7/1/2026.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr, vote passed 6-1, Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt voted no, to approve the birthday leave policy effective 7/1/2026.

Consent Agenda

Motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: January 2026 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the February 16, 2026, regular meeting .

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TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR JANUARY 2026

TAXPAYER NAME	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	MOTOR VEHICLE	MV FEE	SOLID WASTE FEE
RUSSELL WILLIAM H	2010	\$41.01	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
UNKNOWN	2012	\$6.84	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
UNKNOWN	2013	\$7.01	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
UNKNOWN	2014	\$7.06	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SCOTT GWENDOLINE A	2020	\$56.74	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SCOTT GWENDOLINE A	2021	\$48.46	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SCOTT GWENDOLINE A	2022	\$48.46	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SCOTT GWENDOLINE A	2023	\$48.46	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SMITH FAITH VAUGHAN	2023	\$148.41	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
ASANI REAL T LLC	2024	\$0.00	\$31.88	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$125.00
FRAZIER CHAD REYNOLDS	2024	\$1,348.50	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
LYNCH ROY PHILLIP	2024	\$798.88	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
SCOTT GWENDOLINE A	2024	\$80.24	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
WRIGHT MARY	2024	\$467.99	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
MORTON HERBERT P HEIRS	2025	\$1,010.77	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
TAYLOR C S HEIRS	2025	\$599.91	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
MORTON HERBERT P HEIRS	2025	\$1,010.77	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
TAYLOR C S HEIRS	2025	\$599.91	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
MORTON HERBERT P HEIRS	2025	\$2,075.77	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
TAYLOR C S HEIRS	2025	\$1,218.93	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
ALIIS INC	2025	\$749.41	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
ASANI REAL T LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$30.65	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$146.00
BEJARANO JOSUE FLORENTINO	2025	\$18.83	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
FRAZIER CHAD REYNOLDS	2025	\$1,382.95	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
JACKSON ARTHUR FURMAN SR	2025	\$66.77	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
JACKSON ARTHUR FURMAN SR	2025	\$347.65	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00

Upon return to open session, a motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the closed session minutes for January 5, 2026, and February 16, 2026.

A motion was then made by Commissioner Charisse Fain and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. to approve the \$95,000 purchase of the 3.62 acres for the EMS main.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order.

The January 2026 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

At this time, motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to enter into closed session for attorney/client privileges for the Water District Board.

Upon return to open session, motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the closed session minutes for February 16, 2026, Water District Board closed session meeting.

A motion was then made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous to amend the water fee schedule to say individuals will have to pay a \$250 penalty fee for any unauthorized use of water . Also to go ahead send the \$548.58 invoice to retrieve the funds.

A motion was then made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to renew the forgiveness program for another 12 months...if individuals sign up for the program.

At 7:52 p.m. , there was a motion to adjourn the Water District Board. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

As there was no further business, at 7:53 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed April 6, 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair